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Ethan Hardacre

GIS analyst and developer with a B.A. in Computer Science and a background in conservation and public lands. Experienced collecting field data with ArcGIS Field Maps, performing spatial, raster, and geostatistical analysis in ArcGIS Pro, automating workflows with Python and ArcPy, and designing published cartography. Brings production web and mobile development experience (JavaScript, Python, SQL), a geospatial data tool built end-to-end (Zip2KML), and years of translating technical work into clear documentation and training for agency partners, volunteers, and clients. Keen to keep learning new geospatial technology and share it with teammates.

Experience

Regional Trail Stewardship Coordinator — **Oct 2024 - May 2026**
Pacific Crest Trail Association

- Coordinated a trail stewardship program spanning 510 miles of the Pacific Crest Trail, aligning priorities across 13 subdivisions of land management agencies (Forest Service, Bureau of Land Management, and California State Parks), 8 wilderness areas, and 5 volunteer chapters.
- Led 25 field projects in 2025 (2,582 cumulative volunteer hours), using ArcGIS Field Maps in the field and building the planning, budgeting, and reporting systems that let a small staff coordinate work at scale.
- Authored technical and public-facing reports (State of the Trail Report: Southern California) translating field data into clear reporting for partners and funding; taught Trail Scouting at the Forest Service Region 5 Wilderness Ranger Academy.

Trail Crew Member — **2024 Seasonal**
Tahoe Rim Trail Association

- Built and maintained hiking, biking, and equestrian trails on the Tahoe Rim Trail, recording field data with ArcGIS Field Maps.

Product Manager — **Oct 2021 - May 2023**
Pendola Project

- Directed a full website and product redesign (JavaScript, HTML, Kajabi), leading end-to-end build and launch of 6 new digital products for a small, fully remote team; marketing efforts drove 250% growth in 2022.

Software Developer — **Jan 2020 - Jan 2022**
Peak Studios

- Built Zip2KML, a geospatial data tool that converts lists of zip codes into KML map layers viewable in Google Maps, helping clients communicate with their customers.
- Led end-to-end development of a client-facing mobile app (Swift/XCode) and backend services (PHP, SQL, Python), owning the product from architecture through deployment.

Research Assistant / Software Engineer — **May 2018 - Feb 2019**
Pomona College Human Computer Interaction Lab

- Designed and developed open-source collaborative writing software with gaze-sharing features, ran a user study and data analysis, and published results at ACM CHI 2019.

GIS Projects & Publications

Summer Heat Refugia in the Southern California Mountains (in progress)
Interpolating station summer maximum temperatures (GHCN, RAWS, CIMIS) with EBK Regression Prediction in ArcGIS Pro Notebooks, comparing against ordinary kriging and IDW, and overlaying bigcone Douglas-fir occurrences.

Cartograph: Local Expert
Hardacre, Ethan. Published cartography. Trails Magazine, Issue 8, November 2024.

Eye-Write: Gaze Sharing for Collaborative Writing
Papoutsaki A., Hardacre E., Lee K., Kütt G. H. ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems, 2019.

Education

Pomona College
B.A. in Computer Science and Studio Art
Pomona College Scholar (top 25% of class), Moseley Fine Art Prize, Library Undergraduate Research Award
2020

Esri Academy GIS Training
20+ modules: ArcGIS Pro and ArcGIS Online basics, geodatabases, integrating and editing data, managing raster data, ArcPy scripting for geoprocessing and raster analysis, map layouts and map series, geostatistical interpolation, and GeoAI.

Skills & Certifications

GIS & Geospatial
ArcGIS Pro, ArcGIS Online, ArcGIS Field Maps, ArcGIS Pro Notebooks, ArcPy, geodatabases, spatial and raster analysis, geostatistical interpolation (EBK, kriging, IDW), KML

Programming & Data
Python, SQL, JavaScript, HTML, PHP, Swift/XCode, Git/GitHub, debugging

Cartography & Design
Map design and print layout, Adobe Illustrator, Adobe Photoshop, user interface design

Technical writing and documentation, teaching and training, multi-agency coordination, remote team collaboration

Volunteerism

GIS Volunteer
Pacific Crest Trail Association
Oct 2026 - Present

Personal Highlights

Narrative Nonfiction
PCTA State of the Trail Report (2025); Trails Magazine (2024); #21 rising in travel writing on Substack (2025)

Thru-hiking and Bikepacking
6,275 miles of thru-hiking (Pacific Crest, Appalachian, and Arizona Trails) and 2,850 miles of bike touring